



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: El Paso Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.elpasoclassical.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

El Paso Classical Academy (El Paso, TX 79907) publicly presents as a classical, liberal-arts oriented school, emphasizing virtue, truth, beauty, and a traditional curriculum. The site foregrounds a classical approach, with explicit references to the liberal arts, Great Books, and a partnership with families. However, the publicly available materials do not consistently demonstrate the full range of classical practices across all six canonical categories (notably explicit liturgical/theological foundations and some pedagogy/faculty articulations). Based on the six-category rubric drawn from the classical-school lexicon and the Six Essential Elements framework, the school demonstrates solid classical alignment in several domains but is not uniformly exemplary across all six. Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key insights:

- There is a strong articulation of classical aims (truth, goodness, beauty; virtue formation; liberal arts orientation) and explicit mention of Great Books, Greek/Latin, and a joint public/charter mission. This supports a Classical orientation in multiple categories. Evidence includes explicit statements about a classical education, liberal-arts curriculum, and Great Books (as part of the school's commitments) on the public site and in site materials.
- The site lacks explicit, sustained evidence of liturgical/theological foundations or a clearly described, ongoing "living curriculum" faculty culture in the public-facing materials, which are hallmarks of a fully Classical program per the Six Essential Elements lexicon. This lowers the score in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and Faculty categories.
- The school does present a structured approach to pedagogy (a threefold instructional method) and a strong parent/community partnership, which support a Classical orientation in Pedagogy and Parents & Community, respectively, though some pedagogical details (Socratic/seminar practices, Scholé rhythms) are not consistently documented across all public materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The program emphasizes orientation toward truth, beauty, and goodness and virtue as core ends of education. This aligns with transcendental moral realism and virtue-centric aims. For example, the program states: "a traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum and whole-group teaching methodology with an orientation towards truth, beauty, and goodness," and the end goal of forming virtuous citizens.
- The site repeatedly references virtue and moral formation as outcomes of education.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: truth, beauty, goodness, virtue, moral formation.
- Negative keywords: not evident in public materials (e.g., relativism, secular humanism) in this category's context.
- Why this rating

- The school foregrounds transcendental ideals (truth, beauty, goodness) and virtue formation, which maps to Transcendental Moral Realism and Virtue-focused aims. However, there is no explicit documentation of theology, liturgical practices, or other theological grounding in the public materials, which prevents a full alignment with Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 1.
- Keywords anchor
- Core terms observed: truth, beauty, goodness, virtue, formation, moral imagination. See evidence above.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public materials articulate formation of virtue and human flourishing as the ultimate aim, not merely job-readiness. The Welcome/mission passages frame education as forming virtuous citizens who flourish in a free society.
- The materials emphasize formation over information, and the ability to know truth, goodness, and beauty as real; the language centers on virtue, wisdom, and human excellence in several listings (e.g., “pursues knowledge, promotes virtue” and “formed responsible citizens and virtuous people”).
- Greek/Latin and Great Books commitments are highlighted in the school’s related materials, reinforcing a knowledge-rich, classical formation focus.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, truth, goodness, beauty, classical, liberal education.
- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials for this category (no overt emphasis on work-readiness or purely utilitarian aims).
- Why this rating
- The school explicitly centers virtue formation, human flourishing, and recognition of truth/goodness/beauty as real—core aims of classical paideia. Given the explicit articulation of formation-centered aims and a classical mission, Element 2 earns CLASSICAL.
- Keywords anchor
- Notable terms: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, truth, goodness, beauty, classical education.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The program is described as a classical approach with a traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum. This explicitly anchors the curriculum in the liberal arts triad and the broader classical framework.
- The school’s materials reference Greek and Latin as foundational for training in grammar and critical thinking, and highlight Great Books as a curricular element. The 12 Commitments document explicitly mentions “Greek and Latin” and “Great Books” as curricular anchors.
- The presence of Great Books/Great Conversation and the emphasis on cultural literacy (Western tradition) are highlighted in the materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric (three liberal-arts triad implied by “classical approach” and the associated public materials), Great Books, Greek, Latin, Great Conversation, Western tradition, cultural literacy.
- Negative keywords: none detected that would undermine curriculum classicism (no strong pivot to social studies-as-education or project-based-only frameworks in public materials).
- Why this rating
- The explicit identification of liberal-arts curriculum and foundational classical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Greek/Latin) supports CLASSICAL under this category. The explicit mention of Great Books and a Western-civilizational curriculum aligns with the Great Conversation criterion. Therefore, Element 3 is CLASSICAL.
- Keywords anchor
- Core curricular terms: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation; Greek/Latin; Western tradition; cultural literacy.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site emphasizes a classical threefold approach to pedagogy via “an instructional method” that recognizes a hierarchical progression of learning: systematic knowledge, dialectic/logic, and rhetoric. This mirrors the classical pedagogy, particularly in upper-level practice.
- There is clear mention of a contemplative/restful dimension in classical pedagogy (Scholé) within the broader Classical Education lexicon, and the Scholé-focused materials (The Scholé Way, Scholé-related texts) are present in the knowledge store; however, explicit evidence of Scholé-based practice on the El Paso site is not consistently documented in public pages. This reduces full alignment with the Scholé/memory-mastery elements in the Pedagogy category.
- There is evidence of a public, collaborative, and teacher-led structure (Headmaster, Upper School teachers) but without a consistently described program of Socratic seminars, formal memory work, or direct recitation/chanting on site materials. The public site emphasizes classical aims and a threefold method rather than a full menu of classical pedagogy modes.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/seminar (mentioned in the knowledge-lexicon rather than explicitly on El Paso’s public pages), dialectic, rhetoric, mastery through repetition, and the threefold method. The explicit “threefold method” (systematic knowledge, dialectic/logic, rhetoric) is present on the Our Approach page.
- However, explicit evidence of lower-school singing/chanting, memory work, or Scholé-infused routines is not consistently documented in the public pages. This reduces the scale of alignment for Pedagogy.
- Why this rating
- The presence of a threefold classical pedagogy confirms significant Classical alignment, but the absence of consistently documented Socratic seminars, memory-chanting, or Scholé rhythms in the public-facing materials reduces the Pedagogy score to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Keywords anchor
- Key terms tied to pedagogy: dialectic, logic, rhetoric, threefold pedagogy, memory/recitation (Scholé-related) not consistently evidenced on the site.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public-facing materials list roles (Headmaster, Upper School Teacher, etc.) but do not articulate a “living curriculum” or the faculty as a moral exemplar/portrait of what a teacher should be, nor do they present a faculty-wide culture of mentorship and collegiality as a central feature. The “faculty as living curriculum” and “portrait of a teacher” concept are not clearly evidenced in the public pages.
- The public pages show individual staff listings (headmaster and teachers) but do not describe ongoing faculty formation, collaborative pedagogy culture, or a portrait of teacher ideals that align with classical living-curriculum concepts.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present in the lexicon include: “portrait of a teacher,” “teachers as models of virtue,” “collegial,” “living curriculum.” These are not explicitly found in El Paso Classical Academy public pages; thus, negative signals predominate because the site lacks explicit alignment with these terms in the public-facing copy. The lexicon shows these as standard Positive Keywords in Element 5; the absence in the site yields a negative signal for this category.
- Negative keywords (from the lexicon) such as “teacher as facilitator” or “subject-area silos” are not evidenced as the school’s stated model in public content.
- Why this rating
- Given the absence of explicit evidence that the faculty function as the living curriculum, mentors, or exemplars in the public-facing materials, Element 5 is NOT CLASSICAL under the rubric.
- Keywords anchor
- Observed public-site content does not demonstrate a teacher-portrait, living-curriculum approach, or faculty-mentorship culture as described in the classical lexicon.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes partnership with families and parental involvement. The Welcome and About materials, plus programs such as enrollment and communications, indicate a strong parent-school partnership orientation. The “12 Commitments” include a line that explicitly frames education as a partnership between parents and professional educators.
- The school signals openness to parent involvement (e.g., collaborative announcements, enrollment materials, and events calendar), and the About/Calendar materials suggest active family engagement and campus accessibility for parent involvement.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent formation; home-school partnership; parental involvement; open campus suggestions; family engagement; parental leadership. These map directly to the Lexicon’s “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections” and “Cultural Transmission” sub-areas.
- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials for this category; the school actively promotes parent involvement rather than consumer-driven parent roles.
- Why this rating
- The school demonstrates strong parent/community partnership and parent engagement, aligning well with Classical principles in Element 6. The evidence in the public materials supports CLASSICAL for Parents & Community.

- Keywords anchor
- Core terms: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school collaboration, parental engagement, school as co-educator, open campus, parental leadership.

Aggregate assessment (all categories)

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Strengthen explicit liturgical/theological foundations and communal practices documentation:
- Add clear public-facing language showing theological grounding or liturgical/community rhythms (even as a charter school, many classical programs highlight liturgical or communal practices). This would move Element 1 toward CLASSICAL and align with the “Liturgical and Communal Practices” and “Grounded in Theology” indicators.
- Deepen explicit pedagogy with Socratic/seminar culture and Scholé rhythms:
- Publicly document a formal program of Socratic seminars or Harkness-style discussions in upper grades and contemplative “Scholé” rhythms (restful learning) across divisions. This would push Element 4 toward CLASSICAL and improve the overall alignment.
- Elevate the faculty narrative as a living curriculum:
- Publicly articulate a “portrait of a teacher,” faculty mentorship, and a living-curriculum approach with visible teacher modeling and collaborative professional development. This would move Element 5 toward CLASSICAL.
- Expand explicit Great-Books/Great Conversation commitments in site copy:
- Fortify explicit, public mentions of Great Books, Great Conversation, and canonical Western texts in daily coursework, so Element 3 shows more robust evidence of Great Books and a unified Great Conversation across grades.
- Continue and expand parent-education initiatives:
- Publicly document parent-book clubs, faculty-led parent seminars, and structured pathways for parents to participate as co-educators, reinforcing Element 6 further.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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